

Meet ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction: Submitting, Getting Accepted, and Being Involved

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Abstract

The purpose of this meetup is to give CHI attendees a better understanding of ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI). This happens by presenting the goals of TOCHI, giving attendees the opportunity to give input to TOCHI, and by informal discussions between attendees and the editorial board about paper ideas, directions for the journal, and being part of its organization.

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1 Main purpose of the Meetup

The purpose of this meetup is to allow CHI conference attendees to connect with the editorial board of ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI). Attendees will have the opportunity to learn about the journal and share feedback directly with the editorial board. This will help increase the awareness of TOCHI, align the journal better with its readership, and allow potential authors in the journal to ask questions about potential submissions. It also serves as a critical mode of input for TOCHI to develop its future as one of the prime academic venues for HCI in response to the shifting needs of the community and the field.

While TOCHI has fostered and improved its standing within the broader landscape of academic journals in computer science¹, new challenges lie ahead. They include the steep increase of submissions to the journal, which will require an ongoing evolution of TOCHI's editorial and reviewing process; the field's expanding scope that reflects the ever expanding role of digital technology in the human

condition; the effective interplay and position of the journal in relation to conferences in the field of HCI; and the visibility and transferability of the outstanding research published in TOCHI beyond the academy and into society and industry to ensure impact.

The meetup, thus, will serve a space of exchange with a double purpose. On the one hand, practical matters and information will be provided to rise awareness and offer concrete guidance for authors on potential submissions. On the other hand, the editorial board is keen to establish an informal feedback channel to involve the community in the continuous evolution of TOCHI.

2 Activities at the Meetup

The meetup is designed to be practical, interactive, and community-oriented, giving attendees both insights into TOCHI and opportunities to connect directly with the editorial team. It will be structured around three main activities.

1. Introduction to TOCHI (20 minutes). We will begin with an overview of TOCHI—its purpose, scope, and editorial processes. While this presentation will align with the information available on tochi.acm.org, it will go further by highlighting common reasons for rejection, offering practical tips for strengthening submissions, and outlining the various ways to become involved with TOCHI. The session will include both a presentation and a short question-and-answer segment.

2. Open question and answer session with the Editorial Team (30 minutes). The second activity will provide a direct opportunity for attendees to engage with members of the editorial board, outreach editors, and the editor-in-chief. Participants will be able to ask questions, seek advice, and offer suggestions for the journal. This interactive format will encourage an open dialogue about the editorial process and future directions of TOCHI.

3. Small-Group Discussions (40 minutes). The final activity will focus on informal, small-group conversations between attendees and editorial board members. With at least 10 board members present, participants will be distributed across tables, each facilitated by one or two associate editors. These small-group settings will provide space for discussing potential submissions, exploring strategies for

¹<https://www.acm.org/articles/pubs-newsletter/2025/blue-diamond-august-2025#IMPACT>



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writing and publishing with TOCHI, and exchanging perspectives on the journal's role in the broader CHI community.

3 Organizers

This event is organized by members of the TOCHI editorial board, most notable the editor-in-chief (Kasper Hornbæk), the current three outreach editors (Tiffany Do, Irmandy Wicaksano, Sanchari Das), and an associate editors of the journal (Christopher Fraunberger).

In addition to these people, more associate editors will join the meetup to help discuss with prospective authors. At least 18 associate editors have indicated that they will be in attendance, in addition to the authors of this proposal, including Darren Gergle, Elena Glassman, Joanna McGrenere, Yvette Wohn, Adriana Vivacqua, Xiaojuan Ma, Orit Shaer, Helena Mentis, Per Ola Kristensson, Nazanin Andalibi, Eve Hoggan, Erin Solovey, Katherine Isbister, Fabio Paternò, Stacy Marie Branham, Rob Jakob, Zinaida Benenson, and Antti Oulasvirta.

4 Communities

The meetup is highly relevant to CHI attendees because of the strong overlap between the CHI and TOCHI communities. Many

CHI participants actively contribute to TOCHI—whether by submitting articles, reviewing manuscripts, or presenting their TOCHI papers at the conference. Likewise, the TOCHI editorial board is deeply engaged with CHI, not only as authors and reviewers but also through their roles in organizing the conference.

The overall goal of attendees at CHI and authors in TOCHI is also similar. Both are deeply invested in studying and improving human behavior with and around computers. Although CHI emphasizes the timely exchange of cutting-edge ideas through conference presentations, TOCHI provides a venue for more comprehensive, archival contributions. The goal for both is, nevertheless, to offer researchers and practitioners avenues to share their work, gain feedback, and shape the future of HCI.

Finally, this meetup aims to strengthen the sense of community that connects them. We wish to encourage collaboration, cross-pollination of ideas, and a shared understanding of the important role TOCHI plays within the broader CHI ecosystem. In doing so, we also hope to foster an open dialogue about how research flows between conference presentations and journal publications and how these two forms of scholarly communication can best complement each other. By bringing together authors, reviewers, and organizers from both sides, the meetup provides a unique opportunity to build stronger ties, exchange perspectives, and shape the future relationship between CHI and TOCHI.